

WeNext.ai

Meta & WhatsApp Business Platform

Complete FAQ for Clients — Updated March 2026

About this document: This FAQ covers all mandatory Meta/WhatsApp Business Platform requirements your business must complete before you can send templates, activate flows, or scale messaging through WeNext. Every rule here comes directly from Meta's official policies as of 2026.

1. Meta Business Manager Setup

1.1 What is Meta Business Manager and why do I need it?

Meta Business Manager (now called Meta Business Portfolio) is your central hub for all Meta assets — your Facebook Page, WhatsApp Business Account (WABA), ad accounts, and payment methods. You cannot connect to the WhatsApp Business API without an active, verified Business Manager.

1.2 How do I create a Meta Business Manager?

1. Go to business.facebook.com and click "Create Account"
2. Enter your business name, your name, and business email
3. Add your Facebook Page to the Business Manager
4. Complete Business Verification (see Section 2)

1.3 What must be active in Business Manager before onboarding with WeNext?

- A Facebook Page connected to the Business Manager
- Business Verification completed (Meta approval)
- A valid payment method added (credit/debit card)
- A WhatsApp Business Account (WABA) created or connected
- A WhatsApp phone number registered under the WABA

⚠ Important: If any of the above are missing, WeNext cannot activate your WhatsApp API access or send templates on your behalf.

2. Business Verification

2.1 What is Business Verification?

Business Verification is Meta's process of confirming that your business is a legitimate, registered entity. It is mandatory to unlock higher messaging tiers, send certain template categories, and use authentication templates (OTPs).

2.2 What documents does Meta accept for verification?

- GST registration certificate
- Certificate of Incorporation
- Business license or trade license
- Utility bill in the business name (electricity, phone, water)
- Bank statement showing business name

Tip: Your business name on the document must exactly match the name you enter in Business Manager. Even minor mismatches (e.g., "Pvt Ltd" vs "Private Limited") cause rejection.

2.3 How long does verification take?

Typically 2–5 business days. It can take up to 14 days if documents are unclear, incomplete, or if Meta requires additional review. Indian businesses with GST certificates usually get approved faster.

2.4 What happens if verification is rejected?

- Meta sends an email explaining the reason
- You can resubmit with corrected documents immediately
- Common rejection reasons: name mismatch, document too old (must be within 6 months), document not in English (add a certified translation)

2.5 Do I need verification to start testing?

No. Without verification, your account operates at Tier 0 and can send up to 250 messages per day to any WhatsApp number. This is sufficient for testing. However, you cannot send OTP/authentication templates and cannot scale beyond 250 messages without completing verification.

3. Payment Method — Why It Is Mandatory

3.1 Why does Meta require a payment method?

Meta bills you directly for every template message delivered through the WhatsApp Business API. Without a valid payment method on file, your phone numbers may be deactivated and you will be unable to send or receive messages. This applies even if you are using WeNext — Meta's charges come directly to you, not through WeNext.

⚠ **Important:** This is one of the most common blockers we see. Clients assume WeNext handles billing with Meta. We do not. You must add your own payment method directly in Meta Business Manager.

3.2 How do I add a payment method in Meta?

5. Log in to business.facebook.com
6. Go to Settings > Payment Settings
7. Click "Add Payment Method"
8. Select your country (India), choose credit or debit card
9. Enter card details and click Save

Accepted cards: Visa, Mastercard, American Express. International cards work. Prepaid cards and UPI are not accepted by Meta. Use a corporate or business credit card where possible.

3.3 What happens if my payment method fails?

- Meta suspends outbound messaging from your phone number
- You receive an email alert from Meta
- You must update the payment method and clear any outstanding balance
- WeNext cannot unblock this — it must be resolved directly in your Meta Business Manager

4. WhatsApp Messaging Tiers & Limits

4.1 What are messaging tiers?

Meta limits how many unique users your business can message per 24 hours. These limits are called tiers and apply to your entire Business Portfolio (not per phone number) since October 2025. All phone numbers under your Business Manager share the same tier.

Tier	Daily Limit	Requirement	Auto-upgrade
Tier 0	250 messages	No verification	No
Tier 1	2,000 messages	Business verified	Yes
Tier 2	10,000 messages	50% usage in 7 days	Every 6 hrs
Tier 3	100,000 messages	50% usage in 7 days	Every 6 hrs
Unlimited	Unlimited	50% usage in 7 days	Every 6 hrs

New in October 2025: Limits now apply at the Business Portfolio level, not per phone number. New numbers added to your account instantly inherit the portfolio's highest tier. You no longer need to warm up each number separately.

4.2 How do I move from Tier 0 (250 messages) to Tier 1 (2,000)?

You need to complete **ONE** of the following:

- Complete Business Verification in Meta Business Manager, OR
- Send 2,000 delivered messages to unique users within 30 days using high-quality templates, OR
- Have WeNext (as your solution provider) verify your business on your behalf

⚠ Important: Tier 0 is the single biggest operational blocker for new clients. You cannot run any meaningful WhatsApp campaign at 250 messages/day. Complete Business Verification first.

4.3 How does automatic tier upgrade work?

Once you reach Tier 1 (2,000), Meta automatically evaluates your account every 6 hours for upgrade eligibility. To qualify for the next tier:

- Your quality rating must be Medium or High across all templates and phone numbers
- You must have used at least 50% of your current daily limit in the past 7 days
- If both conditions are met, Meta upgrades your tier within 6 hours

4.4 Can my tier be downgraded?

No. As of October 2025, Meta removed automatic tier downgrades. Your quality rating dropping to Low will prevent further upgrades but will not reduce your existing tier. Once you reach a tier, you stay there.

4.5 What is a quality rating and how is it determined?

Your quality rating (High / Medium / Low) reflects how recipients respond to your messages in the past 7 days. It drops when users block your number, report your messages as spam, or ignore them repeatedly. It is checked at the Business Portfolio level since October 2025.

- High quality: Few blocks/reports, good engagement
- Medium quality: Moderate blocks, some reports
- Low quality: High blocks/reports — upgrade eligibility is paused

5. Message Templates — Rules & Approval

5.1 What is a message template and why do I need one?

A message template is a pre-approved message format that allows businesses to initiate conversations with WhatsApp users outside of a customer service window. You cannot send any outbound business-initiated message without an approved template. Templates must be approved by Meta before use.

5.2 How many templates can I have?

- Without an approved display name: up to 250 templates per WABA
- With an approved display name linked to a verified business: up to 6,000 templates per WABA

Practical note: Most businesses operate comfortably within 250 templates. Focus on getting your core templates approved first (welcome, cart recovery, order confirmation) before worrying about the limit.

5.3 What are the template categories?

Meta organises templates into four categories, each with different pricing and rules:

Category	Cost (India)	Free when?	Example
Marketing	~₹0.90/msg	72-hr CTWA window	Sale offers, cart recovery
Utility	~₹0.50/msg	24-hr service window	Order confirm, shipping
Authentication	~₹0.15/msg	72-hr CTWA window	OTPs, login codes
Service	Free	Always free	Replies within 24 hrs

Pricing note: Rates shown are approximate for India recipients. Exact rates depend on the recipient's country code, not your business location. Meta switched from per-conversation to per-message billing in July 2025.

5.4 How long does template approval take?

Template review typically takes between 1 minute and 48 hours. Most templates are approved within a few hours. Rejection usually happens within 24 hours with a reason provided. You can resubmit after fixing the flagged issue.

5.5 Why do templates get rejected?

- Content that violates WhatsApp's commerce or business policies (adult content, gambling, weapons, etc.)
- Template contains only variable placeholders with no fixed text
- Misleading, deceptive, or threatening language
- Requesting sensitive personal or financial information (full card numbers, passwords, national IDs)
- Template body is identical to an existing approved template
- Language mismatch — the selected language does not match the actual content
- Content about alcohol, tobacco, or pharmaceuticals without proper disclaimers

5.6 Can I edit a template after submission?

No. Templates cannot be edited after submission or after they have been sent. If you need to change content, you must delete the template and create a new one. Deleted templates cannot be recreated with the same name for 30 days.

5.7 What is template pacing?

New templates are not sent to all recipients immediately. Meta first delivers them to a small group (around 1,000 users) and monitors quality signals (blocks, reports, engagement). Only if signals are positive does Meta roll out the template to the full audience. Poor early signals can stall your entire campaign.

⚠ Important: Always test new templates with a small warm audience before running large campaigns. A bad template can block your send queue for your entire contact list.

6. Minimum Template Activity to Activate Flows

6.1 Why do I need to send templates before activating flows?

WhatsApp Flows (interactive forms, product catalogues, appointment booking within WhatsApp) require your account to have an established messaging history and a quality rating. A brand new account with zero sent templates cannot activate Flows — Meta requires demonstrable usage before enabling advanced features.

6.2 What is the minimum activity required?

- At least 1 approved template in your WABA
- Minimum template sends to real users to establish a quality signal (Meta does not publish an exact number but WeNext recommends at least 500 delivered messages)
- Quality rating must be Medium or High
- Business Verification must be complete
- Payment method must be active

WeNext guidance: We recommend clients run a simple utility or authentication template campaign to 500–1,000 contacts before attempting to activate Flows. This ensures your account has the quality history Meta needs.

6.3 What is a free entry point (FEP) and how does it help?

A Free Entry Point is when a user initiates a conversation with your business via a Click-to-WhatsApp (CTWA) ad on Facebook or Instagram, or via a WhatsApp button on your Facebook Page. When this happens:

- A 72-hour messaging window opens
- All template messages sent within this window are free (no Meta charges)
- This applies to Marketing, Utility, and Authentication templates

CTWA advantage: This is the biggest cost lever for WeNext clients running CTWA ads. Messages within the 72-hour FEP window are completely free of Meta's per-message charges.

7. Phone Number Requirements

7.1 What type of phone number can I use?

- Any valid phone number that can receive SMS or voice calls for OTP verification
- The number must not already be registered on WhatsApp (personal or business app)
- Virtual numbers, VoIP numbers, and landlines are supported
- The number must be under your business's control — you cannot use someone else's number

7.2 Can I use my existing WhatsApp Business App number?

Yes, but you must migrate it. The number must be disconnected from the WhatsApp Business App before it can be registered on the API. This process deletes your WhatsApp Business App history on that number. WeNext can guide you through the migration process.

7.3 What is a display name and how is it approved?

Your display name is what WhatsApp users see as your business name in conversations. It must comply with Meta's naming guidelines: it must clearly represent your business, cannot be a generic term, and must not be misleading. Display name approval requires Business Verification to be complete first.

⚠ **Important:** Your messaging limit must reach Tier 1 (2,000) before your display name can be approved. Complete verification and send your first batch of templates before expecting display name approval.

7.4 What is the Official Business Account (green tick)?

The green tick (OBA status) is a verification badge that appears next to your business name in WhatsApp conversations. It is not automatic — Meta grants it selectively to well-known brands. Requirements include: Business Verification complete, display name approved, consistent high quality rating, and significant organic WhatsApp presence. WeNext can help you apply but approval is at Meta's sole discretion.

8. Common Blockers & How to Resolve Them

Blocker	Cause	Fix
Cannot send templates	No payment method on file	Add card in Meta Business Manager > Payment Settings
Stuck at 250 msgs/day	Business not verified (Tier 0)	Submit documents for Business Verification
Template rejected	Policy violation or placeholder-only body	Revise content, add fixed text, resubmit
Cannot activate Flows	No messaging history / low quality	Send 500+ templates, maintain quality rating
Display name pending	Tier not reached Tier 1 yet	Complete verification, send first templates
OTP templates blocked	Unverified account	Complete Business Verification first
Phone number deactivated	Payment failure or policy ban	Clear outstanding balance, contact Meta support
Number not approved	Already on WhatsApp personal/ business app	Migrate number off WhatsApp App first

9. Pricing Summary (2026)

Meta switched from per-conversation billing to per-message billing in July 2025. You are now charged for each individual template message delivered, not per 24-hour conversation window.

Key pricing rules to know:

- Service messages (replies within 24 hrs of user-initiated message) are always free
- Utility templates sent within an open 24-hour customer service window are free
- All templates sent within a 72-hour CTWA/FEP window are free (biggest cost saver)
- Marketing messages to US numbers (+1) are currently paused by Meta (since April 2025)
- Pricing varies by recipient's country code — not your business location
- India marketing messages cost approximately ₹0.90/message; Germany costs ~₹11.50/message

WeNext tip: Structure your campaigns to maximise free messaging windows. Run CTWA ads on Meta to open 72-hour free windows, then send your marketing templates within that window at zero Meta cost.

10. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Can WeNext send templates on my behalf without me adding a payment method?

A: No. Meta bills your WhatsApp Business Account directly. WeNext has no ability to pay Meta on your behalf or bypass this requirement. Your payment method in Meta Business Manager must be active before any templates can be sent.

Q: Do I need a separate phone number for WhatsApp API?

A: Yes. The number used for WhatsApp API cannot simultaneously be active on the WhatsApp personal app or WhatsApp Business app. If you want to use your existing number, it must be migrated off the app first.

Q: My Business Verification was rejected. What do I do?

A: Check the rejection email from Meta for the specific reason. Common fixes: ensure the business name matches exactly, use a recent document (within 6 months), provide a translation if the document is not in English, and resubmit. WeNext support can assist you in preparing the correct documents.

Q: How many templates do I need before activating WeNext flows?

A: You need at least 1 approved template, but we recommend sending at least 500 delivered messages across your templates before activating flows. This gives your account the messaging history and quality signal Meta requires.

Q: Can I use a virtual or VoIP number for WhatsApp API?

A: Yes, as long as the number can receive an SMS or voice call during the one-time OTP verification process. After verification, the number does not need to receive calls.

Q: What happens if a user blocks my number?

A: That user can no longer receive your messages. Meta also records the block as a negative quality signal. Too many blocks lower your quality rating and prevent tier upgrades. This is why sending relevant, opted-in messages is critical.

Q: Is there a free tier for WhatsApp API?

A: There is no traditional free tier, but you get free messaging in specific windows: replies within 24 hours of a user-initiated message are free, and all templates within a 72-hour CTWA window are free. New accounts can also test with up to 250 messages/day at Tier 0 without charges until they exceed the free window rules.

Q: Can two WeNext accounts share the same WhatsApp number?

A: No. A WhatsApp Business phone number can only be registered to one WhatsApp Business Account (WABA) at a time. One WABA can have multiple phone numbers, but not the reverse.

Need help? Contact WeNext support at support@wenext.ai or reach your dedicated account manager on WhatsApp.
